Suneha Seetahul

Senior Research Fellow · University of Sydney

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Senior Research Fellow 2023–present
Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work, University of Sydney Business School

- Academic and quantitative lead of the Gender Equality @ Work (GE@W) Index.
- Lead researcher in flagship projects, including the University of Sydney Gender Equality Plan project; Chief Investigator, Working for Women program (Office for Women, 2025–2030).
- Lead of the Centre's Research Fellows committee; supervision of research assistants.

Postdoctoral Research Fellow 2023
Crawford School of Public Policy, Australian National University

Postdoctoral Research Fellow 2019–2021
Department of Political Economy, University of Sydney

Research and Teaching Assistant, PhD Candidate 2013–2019
University of Bordeaux, France

CONSULTANCY AND POLICY ADVISORY POSITIONS

Economist / Social Protection Specialist 2021–2026
World Bank: Social Protection and Jobs Global Practice; Development Impact Evaluation; Indonesia Country Office

- Sierra Leone and Indonesia: food and nutrition security targeting; cash transfers; public works; economic inclusion programs; climate resilience; disability inclusion.

Gender and Labour Research Partner 2022
Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (Investing in Women Initiative), with UN Women

Economist, World Bank Africa Fellow 2021
World Bank Gender Group (competitive program, 3% success rate)

Economist Intern 2012
Chilean Ministry of Economy, Development and Tourism

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics 2013–2018
University of Bordeaux, France
Thesis: *Where does the stigma lie? Exploring the roles of gender, religion and caste in the Indian labour market.* Supervisor: F. Combarnous. Examination committee: B. Harriss-White (University of Oxford), P. Lanjouw (VU Amsterdam), C. Nordman (IRD, DIAL, IZA), U. Rani (ILO), T. Bernard (University of Bordeaux, IFPRI).

MPhil Research in Applied Economics 2012–2013
University of Bordeaux, France

MA Development Practices 2010–2012
University Montesquieu Bordeaux IV, France

BA Economic and Social Management 2007–2010
University Montesquieu Bordeaux IV, France

TEACHING

Unit design and coordination

Human Rights in Development; Human Rights and International Development 2019–2020
University of Sydney, Department of Political Economy
Unit coordinator and lecturer. Designed and delivered units centred on the Sustainable Development Goals, examining development policy and practice through a multidisciplinary lens, including lectures and assessment.

Global Classroom on Development Policy 2019
University of Sydney, with the University of Toronto and the Tata Institute of Social Sciences
Academic lead. Designed and led a cross-institutional global classroom on development policy. Delivery mode adapted to COVID-19.

Research Methods in Development Economics 2016–2017
University of Bordeaux, France (postgraduate)
Unit coordinator and lecturer. Designed and taught research design and empirical methods in development economics, using published studies to introduce students to experimental and quasi-experimental designs.

Statistical Analysis 2016–2017
University of Bordeaux, France (postgraduate)
Unit coordinator and lecturer. Designed and taught applied statistical and data analysis in Stata around a single case study using real-world data, taking students from data cleaning through to estimating a causal model.

Lecturing

Gender, Work and Care in Economic Life 2026
University of Sydney, ECOP3624/ECOP6624 (undergraduate and postgraduate)
Guest lecturer. *Gender and data*: lecture on gender-sensitive measurement, global gender data gaps and their causes, and big data and algorithmic bias, with in-class activities on gender metrics and on the class's own time-use survey data.

Intermediate PPE 2026
University of Sydney, BPPE2000 (undergraduate)
Guest lecturer (co-delivered). *The political economy of gender data*: how gender evidence is produced and translated into policy tools, using the Gender Equality @ Work Index as a case study.

Foundations of Work and Employment 2026
University of Sydney, WORK1003 (undergraduate)
Guest lecturer. *Work and gender*: lecture on the main dimensions of gender inequality in the labour market, using the Gender Equality @ Work Index as a case study.

Global Development; Economic Development: Growth and Wellbeing 2023–2026
University of Sydney, ECOP3619 (undergraduate) and ECOP6018 (postgraduate)
Guest lecturer, annually. *Social policy and development*: contemporary debates on social policy as a development tool in low- and middle-income countries.

Interdisciplinary Impact 2025
University of Sydney (undergraduate)
Academic and industry partner.

Measuring Gender Inequalities in Developing Countries 2024
Universidad de La Frontera, Chile
Guest lecturer.

Interdisciplinary Impact 2021
University of Sydney (undergraduate)
Workshop lead.

Discrimination in Developing Labour Markets 2019
Artois University, France
Guest lecturer.

Tutoring

Microeconomics 2013–2019
University of Bordeaux, France (undergraduate)
Tutor. Weekly tutorials.

Descriptive Statistics 2013–2019
University of Bordeaux, France (undergraduate)
Tutor. Weekly tutorials.

Statistical Analysis in Stata 2013–2019
University of Bordeaux, France (undergraduate)
Tutor. Computer lab sessions.

SUPERVISION AND MENTORING

Supervision

Co-supervisor, Honours thesis 2026
University of Sydney, Political Economy
Gender gap in superannuation among migrants in Australia.

PhD examination jury member 2024
Université Paris-Dauphine, France

Co-supervisor, pre-doctoral research internships 2022, 2023
INRAE, France
Two pre-doctoral research interns hosted at INRAE.

Supervisor, Master's capstone projects 2019–2020
University of Sydney

Co-supervisor, Honours thesis 2019
University of Sydney, Political Economy

Supervisor, Master's dissertations 2016–2017
University of Bordeaux, France
Four Master's dissertations in development economics.

Mentoring

- Mentor to early and mid-career researchers at the Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work, on quantitative methods, research and career development.
- Supervision and training of research assistants.

RESEARCH FUNDING AND AWARDS

Gender Equality @ Work Index 2025–2026
Research partnership with the Minderoo Foundation
Co-Lead Investigator, with Prof. Hill. AUD 660,000.

Working for Women 2025–2030
Research partnership with the Office for Women, Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet
Chief Investigator. Lead Chief Investigators: Prof. Cooper and Prof. Hill. AUD 5,000,000.

Building Women's Careers Program 2025–2028
Research partnership with the Department of Employment and Workplace Relations
Investigator. Lead Chief Investigator: Prof. Cooper. AUD 500,000.

University of Sydney Gender Equality Plan project 2026
Research partnership with the University of Sydney
Lead Researcher. Co-designed the proposal with the Centre's Director, Deputy Director and Advisor.

Horizon Europe Strategic Partnership Fund, Network and Engagement Grant 2026
University of Sydney, with the Universities of Sussex, Leeds, Manchester and Copenhagen
Investigator. Lead Chief Investigator: Prof. Cooper. AUD 10,000. Consortium building for a Horizon Europe proposal on technology, job quality and equality.

Sydney Collaborative Research Equipment and NHMRC Equipment Grants Scheme 2026
Sydney Informatics Hub, University of Sydney
Co-Lead Investigator. AUD 5,000.

Digitalised ideal workers? Impacts of AI on Australia's ageing and gender-segregated workforce 2025–2026
Australian Labour and Employment Relations Association (ALERA)
Chief Investigator. Lead Chief Investigator: Dr Good. AUD 10,000.

Targeting food and nutrition security in social protection, Sierra Leone 2024–2026
World Bank Social Protection Response Umbrella Program (Food and Nutrition Security Window), financed by the Government of Norway and the Gates Foundation; with NaCSA, Sierra Leone
Chief Investigator. USD 225,000.

Quantum workforces 2024
Sydney Nano Institute, University of Sydney
Investigator, with Prof. Cooper, Prof. Hill and Prof. Groutsis. AUD 30,000.

Socioeconomic dimensions and determinants of obesity in the Pacific Islands 2021–2023
Australia-France Collaborative Research Program: Academy of the Social Sciences in Australia, INRAE and University of Sydney
Chief Investigator, with Dr Levasseur. AUD 5,000.

Gender and climate in African countries 2021
Afrobarometer Research Initiative, Afrobarometer and World Bank Group
Chief Investigator. USD 1,500.

PUBLICATIONS

Most economics papers list authors alphabetically, following the convention of the discipline.

Books

Hill, E., Foley, M., **Seetahul, S.**, Cooper, R., Vromen, A., & Gina, Z. (2027, forthcoming). *The future of work and care: Young voices and decent work in Australia, Japan and the United Kingdom*. Bristol University Press. Publisher page

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Levasseur, P., Rouly, S., & **Seetahul, S.** (2026). Water insecurity and purchases of soft and sweet beverages: A case study in the obesogenic context of the Pacific Islands. *Journal of the Asia Pacific Economy*, *31*(1), 325–342. doi:10.1080/13547860.2024.2424652 ABDC B

Clément, M., Levasseur, P., & **Seetahul, S.** (2025). Sex ratio and fertility preferences in India: A longitudinal analysis. *World Development*, *192*, 107046. doi:10.1016/j.worlddev.2025.107046 ABDC A*

Alvarez-Saavedra, V., Levasseur, P., & **Seetahul, S.** (2023). The role of gender inequality in the obesity epidemic: A case study from India. *Journal of Development Studies*, *59*(7), 980–996. doi:10.1080/00220388.2023.2191778 ABDC A

Alvarez-Saavedra, V., Levasseur, P., & **Seetahul, S.** (2022). Violation des droits des femmes et malnutrition en Inde : vers de nouvelles formes d'inégalités ? *Mondes en développement*, *197*(1), 41–58. doi:10.3917/med.197.0045

Clément, M., Levasseur, P., **Seetahul, S.**, & Piaser, L. (2021). Does inequality have a silver lining? Municipal income inequality and obesity in Mexico. *Social Science & Medicine*, *272*, 113710. doi:10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.113710 ABDC A*

Michiels, S., Nordman, C. J., & **Seetahul, S.** (2021). Many rivers to cross: Social identity, cognition, and labor mobility in rural India. *The Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science*, *697*(1), 66–80. doi:10.1177/00027162211055990 ABDC B

Clément, M., Levasseur, P., & **Seetahul, S.** (2020). Is excess weight penalised or rewarded in middle-income countries' labour markets? Comparative evidence from China, India and Mexico. *Kyklos*, *73*(2), 161–195. doi:10.1111/kykl.12220 ABDC A

Deguilhem, T., & **Seetahul, S.** (2016). Modèles de mélange fini (FMM) appliqués à la segmentation du marché du travail à Bogota. *Bulletin of Sociological Methodology / Bulletin de Méthodologie Sociologique*, *132*(1), 26–43. doi:10.1177/0759106316662589

Work in progress

Seetahul, S., Hill, E., Cooper, R., & Bedi, A. An integrated approach to identify, measure and address gender inequality in the labour market. Revise and resubmit, *Social Indicators Research*. ABDC A

Seetahul, S., Bedi, A., Foeken, E., Dabaja, I., & Good, L. Generative AI and job quality in an ageing workforce. Under review, *ILR Review*. ABDC A*

Good, L., **Seetahul, S.**, Foeken, E., & Dabaja, I. Segmentation, stereotypes and social reproduction: Gender inequality and technological change at work. In A. Pekarek & J. Healy (Eds.), *Employment relations at the digital frontier*. Book chapter under review.

Seetahul, S., Healy, J., & Cooper, R. Methods of setting pay and the gender pay gap. In preparation for *Journal of Industrial Relations*. ABDC A

Seetahul, S., & Stadler, B. Parental leave design and gender norms in 25 high-income countries. In preparation for *Feminist Economics*. ABDC A

Seetahul, S. Climate shocks and gender norms in Africa. In preparation.

Seetahul, S., Stoeffler, Q., & Mendonca, F. Food and nutrition security targeting in Sierra Leone. In preparation.

Policy reports

Hill, E., **Seetahul, S.**, Cooper, R., & Bedi, A. (2026, forthcoming). *Gender Equality @ Work Index: 2026 national index report*. Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work, University of Sydney.

Seetahul, S., Stoeffler, Q., Mendonca, F., Williams, A., & Buya-Kamara, H. (2026). *Targeting food insecurity in social protection: Insights from Sierra Leone*. World Bank. Report

Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work. (2026). *The NHMRC and gender equality* (Research briefing for the Hon. Rebecca White MP, Assistant Minister for Health and Aged Care, Indigenous Health and Women). University of Sydney. Briefing

Cooper, R., Foeken, E., Healy, J., Hill, E., Loh, V., Liu, J., Colussi, S., & **Seetahul, S.** (2026). *Choice, voice and control: NSW nurses and midwives' experiences and aspirations in hours, rostering and flexibility at work*. Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work. doi:10.25910/2aht-1h78

Hill, E., Cooper, R., **Seetahul, S.**, & Bedi, A. (2025). *Gender Equality @ Work Index: Index report, November 2025*. Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work. doi:10.25910/e34w-8860

Hill, E., Cooper, R., **Seetahul, S.**, Basu, S., & Kent, J. (2025). *Building good jobs for women on the Central Coast*. Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work. doi:10.25910/cffm-z314

Cooper, R., Hill, E., Foley, M., Harris, M., Hock, C., Tapsell, A., & **Seetahul, S.** (2024). *"Just another day in retail": Understanding and addressing workplace sexual harassment in the Australian retail industry* (Research report). ANROWS. Report

Hill, E., Cooper, R., Lee, T., & **Seetahul, S.** (2024). *Building a more equitable future of work for women in NSW: Opportunities for government action* (Policy Insights Paper). James Martin Institute for Public Policy (now Australian Public Policy Institute). Report

Hill, E., Cooper, R., Vromen, A., Foley, M., & **Seetahul, S.** (2023). *Gender dynamics in the post-pandemic future of work: High level data release for International Women's Day 2023* (Research Note 1). University of Sydney. hdl:2123/30078

Seetahul, S., & Giron, L. (2022). *Incorporating climate resilience in economic inclusion programs: Global examples and lessons for Sierra Leone* (Social Protection and Jobs Working Document). World Bank. Available upon request.

Seetahul, S. (2022). *Public works programs and climate change: What can we learn from the literature and from existing programs?* (Social Protection and Jobs Working Document). World Bank. Available upon request.

Seetahul, S. (2022). *Disability inclusion in economic inclusion and public works programs: Rapid review of selected case studies and lessons for Sierra Leone* (Social Protection and Jobs Working Document). World Bank. Available upon request.

Hill, E., Baird, M., & **Seetahul, S.** (2020). *COVID-19 and the private sector*: Country reports for Indonesia, Myanmar, the Philippines and Viet Nam (4 reports). Investing in Women and UN Women. Indonesia, Myanmar, Philippines, Viet Nam

Working papers

Adhikari, S., & **Seetahul, S.** (2023). *Candle in the wind? Insights from COVID-19 emergency cash transfers to informal sector workers in Sierra Leone* (Policy Research Working Paper No. 10395). World Bank. WP

Halim, D., & **Seetahul, S.** (2023). *Why do people move? A data-driven approach to identifying and predicting gender-specific aspirations to migrate* (Policy Research Working Paper No. 10396). World Bank. WP

Michiels, S., Nordman, C. J., & **Seetahul, S.** (2021). *Many rivers to cross: Social identity, cognition and labour mobility in rural India* (IZA Discussion Paper No. 14807). IZA Institute of Labor Economics. WP

Writing for wider audiences

Seetahul, S., Clément, M., & Levasseur, P. (2026, February 6). Do skewed sex ratios reduce son preference? *VoxDev*. VoxDev

Hill, E., Cooper, R., & **Seetahul, S.** (2025). Progress on gender equality at work is slow and uneven, new index finds. *The Conversation*. The Conversation

Levasseur, P., & **Seetahul, S.** (2024). Without clean water, Pacific Islanders turn to sugary drinks. Tackling this could reduce obesity. *The Conversation*. The Conversation

Baird, M., Hill, E., & **Seetahul, S.** (2020). COVID-19 and gender in the South-East Asian private sector. *SSPS Review*, *11*. SSPS Review

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND ENGAGEMENT

Conferences (2026). CALIBER AI Summit, Melbourne (November); ILERA World Congress, Tokyo; SASE Annual Conference, Bordeaux; HILDA Survey Research Conference, Melbourne; AIRAANZ, Sydney; Work and Organisational Studies seminar, University of Sydney.

Invited presentations. Launch of the Gender Equality @ Work Index by the Hon. Rebecca White MP, Assistant Minister for Women, Parliament House, Canberra (2025); Lowy Institute, Sydney (water insecurity and obesity in the Pacific); International Labour Organization, Geneva.

Panels and public talks. Sydney Ideas, *Beyond the pay gap: Rethinking gender equality at work*; University of Sydney MBA discussion forum; Charles Perkins Centre International Women's Day event; School of Physics diversity, equity and inclusion event; Raising the Bar ("Gender equality at work: lessons from around the world").

Media. *In the Black*; Eastside Radio; *National Indigenous Times*; INRAE News; Mirage News.

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Lead Researcher and member of the Advisory Group 2026
University of Sydney Gender Equality Plan

Lead, Research Fellows committee 2026–present
Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work

Convenor, Early and Mid-Career Researcher (EMCR) seminar series 2024–2026
Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work

Member, research group on domestic, family and sexual violence present
SYNC-DFSV, University of Sydney

Earlier service (France, 2014–2018). Elected board member, Law, Political Sciences, Economics and Management Board, University of Bordeaux (2014–2018); convenor, Development Economics Seminar of Bordeaux, GREThA (2016–2017); Vice-President, Association des Jeunes Études Indiennes, and organiser of its 2018 annual workshop at ENS Paris-Saclay (2018); volunteer running a weekly seminar supporting migrant students' integration into French higher education (2017–2018).

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages. French (native); Mauritian Creole (native); English (bilingual, TOEFL 116/120); Spanish (fluent); Hindi (conversational).

Software and programming. Stata, R, Python, SPSS, NVivo, Microsoft Access, Tableau, LaTeX, Quarto, Git and GitHub.

Teaching tools. Canvas, Moodle, Padlet, Menti, Datawrapper.

REFERENCES

Prof. Elizabeth Hill, Professor, Department of Political Economy, University of Sydney. Deputy Director, Australian Centre for Gender Equality and Inclusion at Work; co-convenor, Australian Work and Family Policy Roundtable and Body@Work Project.
elizabeth.hill@sydney.edu.au

Prof. Matthieu Clément, Professor of Economics, University of Bordeaux, and researcher at the Bordeaux School of Economics (CNRS, INRAE, University of Bordeaux). Director, Master's program in Development Economics.
matthieu.clement@u-bordeaux.fr